

Tutorial 1

Daily Market Map: Weekly Chart, Floors, Pivots, and Invalidation

Start every trading day by mapping the larger battlefield before looking for an intraday entry.

Student Guide | Trading Education Workbook

Purpose of this handout

This document turns one coaching topic into a focused lesson, practice routine, and homework assignment. It is written for education and paper-trading practice only. It is not financial advice and does not recommend buying, selling, shorting, or holding any security.

Source of the lesson

Based on the coaching conversation with Val and Adel on technical execution, risk management, and chart study. External references are included to deepen the concept and give the student reliable follow-up reading.

How to use this tutorial

1. Read the objective and key terms first.
2. Study the chart logic slowly before trying to trade it.
3. Complete the practice drill using paper trading or chart replay.
4. Answer the homework questions at the end in writing.

Learning Objective

By the end of this tutorial, the student should be able to open a chart, start from the weekly timeframe, identify the most important floor, ceiling, pivot/unsafe zone, and invalidation level, then decide whether the current environment is appropriate for scalping or should be avoided.

One-sentence lesson

A trader should map structure before trading price, because the same intraday setup behaves differently when it sits near a weekly floor, a pivot zone, or structural resistance.

Key Terms

Term	Student Definition	Use in the Lesson
Weekly floor	The lowest meaningful area price has held during the current or recent weekly structure.	Used to understand where demand may appear before intraday decisions are made.
Pivot zone	An area where price previously flipped direction and can attract/reject price quickly.	Treated as unsafe because price can move sharply in either direction.
Structural resistance	A static chart level where prior supply appeared.	Used to decide when scalping might shift into momentum only after confirmation.
Invalidation	The level where the trade idea is no longer valid.	Used to stop trading or exit rather than hoping.
Confluence	Several tools or levels pointing to the same area.	Gives a level more importance than a single line alone.

Start high timeframe first: weekly -> daily -> 30m -> 15m -> 5m

Structural resistance / decision point

Pivot / unsafe zone: price can flip quickly

Weekly floor / accumulation zone

Invalidation: thesis is wrong below here

Why the Weekly Chart Comes First

In the coaching session, Val was reminded to start every day on the weekly chart before moving to smaller timeframes. This prevents the student from treating a small intraday candle as more important than the larger structure around it.

The weekly chart helps answer four questions: Where is the major floor? Where is the ceiling? Where is the unsafe pivot zone? Where is the thesis wrong? Once these are marked, the smaller timeframes become easier to read because the student knows what price is approaching.

Historical example from the coaching session

The Tesla discussion used a weekly floor/accumulation zone and a pivot near 368.40 as examples. These were historical teaching levels from that session, not recommendations or current trading levels.

Support Is Not the Same as a Pivot

A support zone is an area where demand may defend price. A pivot zone is more dangerous: it is a place where price has shown the ability to flip quickly between bullish and bearish behavior. The student should not label every important line as support.

Near a pivot, the safer mindset is: "This area is unstable. I must trade smaller, faster, and only with clear invalidation." This is why Adel emphasized that the trade was a scalp rather than a position trade.

Daily Map Decision Table

Chart Condition	Student Interpretation	Action Bias	
Price near weekly floor	Potential demand zone, but still needs intraday confirmation.	Watch for reclaim, hold, or failure.	
Price inside pivot/unsafe zone	Price can flip fast; direction is uncertain.	Scalp only, smaller risk, tighter invalidation, or no trade.	
Price below invalidation	The original idea is wrong.	Exit or stop looking for the same setup.	
Price cleanly above structural resistance	Possible regime shift from scalp to momentum.	Wait for higher-timeframe confirmation before changing style.	

The Morning Mapping Routine

1. Open the weekly chart first. Do not start on the 1-minute or 2-minute chart.
2. Mark the weekly floor and label it clearly.
3. Mark the most obvious structural resistance above price.
4. Mark any pivot/unsafe zone where price has flipped before.
5. Mark the invalidation level: the price where the idea is wrong.
6. Only then move to the 30-minute, 15-minute, 5-minute, and 2-minute charts.

Chart Markup Checklist

Action	Done
Weekly floor is marked and labeled.	
Pivot/unsafe zone is marked and labeled differently from support.	
Structural resistance is marked as a static line or zone.	
Invalidation level is marked before any trade is considered.	
The student can explain why the current setup is scalp, momentum, swing, or no-trade.	
The student has checked whether the smaller timeframe agrees with the larger map.	

Common Mistakes

- Starting with a fast chart and becoming emotionally attached to the first candle seen.
- Calling every horizontal line support or resistance without asking whether it is actually a pivot.
- Entering a scalp near an unsafe pivot and then treating it like a multi-day position.
- Moving the invalidation line after price goes against the plan.
- Ignoring the higher timeframe because the 2-minute chart looks exciting.

Research References

Use these references to deepen the lesson. They are educational sources; they do not replace a written trading plan or broker-specific rules.

1. CMT Association - Trendlines & Channels Tutorial, Part 1. Explains trendlines/channels as tools for reading supply and demand rather than magic signals.
<https://cmtassociation.org/tradingview-ideas/xdgijtpy-trendlines-channels-tutorial-part-1/>
2. CMT Association - Trendline and Channel Tutorial, Part 4. Discusses resistance confluence and the use of preferred entry and stop-placement methods around confluence areas.
<https://cmtassociation.org/tradingview-ideas/qigbbi2b-trendline-and-channel-tutorial-part-4/>
3. StockCharts ChartSchool - Support and Resistance. Defines support/resistance as areas where supply and demand meet.
<https://chartschool.stockcharts.com/table-of-contents/chart-analysis/support-and-resistance>

Homework - Complete Before the Next Session

Complete this map on 10 different tickers or replay charts. The goal is not to predict the next move; the goal is to know where price is dangerous.

Question / Prompt	Student Answer
What is the weekly floor on your chosen chart, and why did you mark that area?	
What is the most important pivot/unsafe zone, and what makes it different from support?	
Where is structural resistance above price?	
Where is the invalidation level for a bullish scalp idea?	
If price enters the pivot zone, should you scalp, hold, or avoid? Explain.	
Which timeframe gave the clearest structure: weekly, daily, 30-minute, or 15-minute?	
What would need to happen before you call the setup momentum instead of scalp?	
List one mistake you almost made while mapping the chart.	

Submission Checklist

Item to Submit	Done
10 screenshots with weekly floor, pivot, resistance, and invalidation labeled.	
One written paragraph explaining the most dangerous chart.	
One example where you chose no-trade because the map was unclear.	